



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Sun, Aug 9, 2026 · 6:12 PM MDT
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

2.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Sun 9:00 AM: **2.5**

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Low Risk	2.5	Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.	Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.

Active Environment Canada Alerts

Severe Thunderstorm Watch — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 22.2°C and feels near 22.7°C. Winds are 1 km/h from SW, gusting near 14 km/h.
- Environment Canada has 1 active alert(s) in effect for the venue: severe thunderstorm watch.
- The nearest current AQHI is 2 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is unavailable (forecast tonight: 4, tomorrow: 2).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 1.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 21.9 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_EFMF-Office', 0.3 km) reads 20.9 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 20.7 km to the NE, i.e. arriving from the NE.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-09) is 39.4 km NE of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory does not pass near this fire (nearest approach 20.1 km), so this specific fire is unlikely to be the source of any smoke reaching the venue right now.
- The AQHI forecast for Sun 9:00 AM is 2.
- Overall operational environmental risk is LOW.

Recommendations

- Active Environment Canada alert(s) for the venue — review details: severe thunderstorm watch.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: Low Risk

AIR QUALITY Low Risk 2.5 AQHI	HEAT Low Risk 24.7 °C apparent/humidex	WIND Low Risk 16.6 km/h peak gust	PRECIPITATION Low Risk 0.1 mm/h maximum	THUNDERSTORM Low Risk — first forecast signal
AQHI RATE OF CHANGE Low Risk 0.0 AQHI change/hour		WIND SHEAR Low Risk 16.7 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m)		

Local Monitoring

Nearest station 2.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 1.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 21.9 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 20.9 µg/m³ ACA_EFMF-Office · 0.31 km
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